

Here is the complete text from the provided PDF regarding Milkha Singh, organized by the sections in the document:

Milkha Singh: The Flying Sikh

Milkha Singh (born between 1929 and 1935), also known as "The Flying Sikh," was an Indian former track and field sprinter who was introduced to the sport while serving in the Indian Army. He was the only Indian athlete to win an individual athletics gold medal at a Commonwealth Games until 2010. In recognition of his sporting achievements, he was awarded the Padma Shri, India's fourth-highest civilian honour.

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International Career

- **Olympic Participation:** He represented India in the 1956 (Melbourne), 1960 (Rome), and 1964 (Tokyo) Summer Olympics.
- **1956–1958:** He competed in the 200m and 400m at the Melbourne Games. In 1958, he set records for both distances at the National Games of India in Cuttack and won gold medals in the same events at the Asian Games.

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- **Commonwealth Success:** He became the first gold medalist from independent India at the Commonwealth Games by winning the 440 yards (400m) in 46.6 seconds.

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- **1960–1962:** After being persuaded by Jawaharlal Nehru to race in Pakistan, he successfully competed against Abdul Khaliq in 1960. Some sources note he set a world record of 45.8 seconds in France shortly before the Rome Olympics, where he ultimately placed 4th.

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- **Final Gold:** At the 1962 Asian Games in Jakarta, he won gold in the 400m and the $4 \times 400\text{m}$ relay.

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The Legend of "The Flying Sikh"

Milkha Singh was the first Sikh and the only Indian to have broken an Olympic track record and the first Indian to reach Olympic Finals. Described as a "genius" who succeeded without formal training or financial reward, he overcame the loss of his parents during Partition with only the support of his siblings. His speed in breaking the previous Olympic record of 45.9 seconds (noted as 5.9 in source text) is part of Punjab's folklore. In India, his popularity is likened to that of Pele in Brazil or Maradona in Argentina.

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Personal Life and Legacy

- **Family:** In 1962, he married Nirmal Kaur, the captain of the Indian women's volleyball team. They had three daughters and one son, Jeev Milkha Singh, who is a famous golfer. In 1999, the couple adopted the seven-year-old son of a soldier who died in the Battle of Tiger Hill.

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- **Philanthropy:** Singh donated all his medals to the nation, which were displayed at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium. In 2003, he founded the Milkha Singh Charitable Trust to assist needy sportspersons